

SAP Profile Analyzer

User Guide

For SAP Basis administrators comparing and reconciling instance and DEFAULT profiles across systems.

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Contents

Contents	2
1. Introduction	4
1.1 What this tool does	4
2. Getting Started.....	4
2.1 Uploading profile files	4
2.2 Pasting profile text	4
2.3 Removing a profile or starting over	5
3. Understanding the Comparison Table	5
3.1 Color coding	5
3.2 Icons and badges.....	5
3.3 Profile columns and SID detection.....	6
4. Filtering and Navigating	6
4.1 View modes.....	6
4.2 Search.....	6
4.3 Grouping by category.....	6
4.4 Jumping between rows	7
4.5 Reordering and pinning columns	7
5. Setting a Baseline	7
6. Excluding Parameters.....	7
6.1 Marking a parameter as excluded	7
6.2 Adding a reason	8
6.3 Showing or hiding excluded rows	8
7. Ignoring SID-Based Differences.....	8
8. Proposing Fixes (Remediation Workflow).....	8
8.1 Opening the propose-fix panel	8
8.2 Choosing an action per profile	8
8.3 Matching the baseline value	9
8.4 Adding notes	9
8.5 Marking a decision	9
8.6 Tracking progress	9

9. Saving and Loading Comparisons.....	9
10. Exporting Reports	10
10.1 Excel report	10
10.2 PDF comparison report	10
10.3 Remediation plan (PDF)	11
10.4 Choosing the right export	11
11. Quick Reference: Summary Statistics	11
12. Tips for Basis Teams.....	12
13. Data and Privacy	12
14. Support and Contact	12

1. Introduction

SAP Profile Analyzer is a browser-based tool for comparing SAP instance and DEFAULT profile files side by side. This guide covers how to use it day to day — uploading profiles, reading the comparison, proposing fixes, and exporting reports for your team. It assumes you already know what SAP profiles and parameters are and what they control; it does not cover that background.

1.1 What this tool does

At its core, the tool takes two or more SAP profile files and shows every parameter that appears in any of them, side by side, in a single table. It automatically tells you:

- which parameters have the same value everywhere,
- which parameters have different values across profiles,
- which parameters exist in some profiles but not others,
- which profiles contain duplicate entries for the same parameter, and
- which parameters look like they might have a data-type inconsistency (e.g. numeric in one profile, text in another).

From there, you can filter the view down to just what matters, pick one profile as a baseline to measure the others against, mark parameters that are expected to differ so they stop cluttering your analysis, propose exactly how each difference should be fixed, and export the results as a spreadsheet or a print-ready report your Basis team can act on.

Everything happens inside your browser. Profile files are never uploaded to a server — the comparison, the exports, and the reports are all generated locally on your machine.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Uploading profile files

Drag and drop one or more profile files onto the upload area near the top of the page, or click it to open a file browser. You can add more files later the same way — new profiles are simply added alongside the ones already loaded.

The tool accepts any plain-text profile file regardless of its extension (DEFAULT.PFL, instance profiles like PRD_DVEBMGS00_hostname, and so on). If a file is uploaded that doesn't look like a valid profile (no key = value lines could be found), a warning banner appears telling you which file to check.

2.2 Pasting profile text

If you have profile content in a ticket, email, or clipboard rather than as a file, click “or paste profile text instead” below the upload area. Give it a name (ideally matching the real filename, e.g. DEFAULT.PFL or PRD_DVEBMGS00) and paste the parameter lines in, then click Add profile. Naming

it correctly matters because the tool uses the filename to detect the profile's SAP SID for DEFAULT profiles (see section 3.3).

2.3 Removing a profile or starting over

Each uploaded profile appears as a small chip above the table, showing its filename, parameter count, and duplicate count if any. Click the X on a chip to remove that profile, or use Clear all to remove everything and start fresh.

3. Understanding the Comparison Table

Once at least one profile is loaded, the main table shows every distinct parameter name found across all loaded profiles as a row, and each profile as a column.

3.1 Color coding

A thin colored bar on the left edge of each row, and a tint on each value cell, tell you the status of that parameter at a glance:

Color	Meaning
Green	The parameter has the same value in every profile that has it.
Amber	The parameter is present in every profile, but with different values.
Red	The parameter is missing from at least one profile.
Gray / faded row	The parameter has been excluded from analysis (see section 6).

3.2 Icons and badges

Icon / badge	Meaning
Copy icon (violet)	This parameter has duplicate entries within one or more profile files. Hover over the affected cell to see every occurrence and the line number it came from.
Octagon icon (teal)	Type mismatch — the value looks numeric in one profile and non-numeric in another, which can indicate a misconfiguration even when the underlying values technically “match” in status.
“SID” badge (blue)	Shown only when “Ignore SID differences” is turned on (section 7). It marks a row that would otherwise show as different, but was treated as matching because the only difference was each profile's own system ID.

Checkmark icon (green)	A fix has been proposed and marked as decided for this parameter (section 8).
Speech-bubble icon (gray)	This parameter is excluded and has a reason attached — hover to read it.
Wrench icon	Click to open the propose-fix panel for a Different or Missing parameter.

3.3 Profile columns and SID detection

Each profile is shown as a column, labeled with its filename. If a profile is a DEFAULT profile (its filename contains “default”) and the tool could detect the system's SAP SID from its content, the SID is shown underneath the filename in the column header and next to the name in the profile chip — this makes it easy to tell which DEFAULT.PFL belongs to which system when comparing several at once.

4. Filtering and Navigating

4.1 View modes

A row of buttons above the table lets you filter what's shown:

- **All** — every parameter.
- **Matching** — only parameters identical across all profiles.
- **Different** — only parameters with differing values.
- **Missing** — only parameters absent from at least one profile.
- **Duplicates** — only parameters that have duplicate entries in at least one profile.
- **Type Mismatch** — only parameters flagged with the numeric/text inconsistency described above.
- **vs Baseline** — appears once a baseline is set (section 5); shows only parameters that differ from the baseline.

4.2 Search

Type into the Filter parameters box to narrow the table to parameter names containing that text. This combines with whichever view mode is active.

4.3 Grouping by category

By default, parameters are grouped into collapsible sections by their SAP namespace prefix — for example, all rdisp/ parameters together, all login/ parameters together, and so on. Click a group's

header row to expand or collapse it, or use Expand all / Collapse all to do it for every group at once. If you'd rather see one continuous list, click “Grouped by category” to switch to “Flat list”.

4.4 Jumping between rows

Two buttons help you move through the table without scrolling manually:

- **Jump to next difference** — cycles through every Different, Missing, or Type Mismatch row, expanding its category group automatically if needed.
- **Jump to next pending decision** — cycles specifically through Different/Missing rows that don't yet have a decided proposal, which is useful while working through a remediation session (section 8).

4.5 Reordering and pinning columns

Each column header has three small controls: left and right arrows to move that profile's column, and a pin icon to move it straight to the front. This is useful once you have several profiles loaded and want the two you care about most side by side.

5. Setting a Baseline

Click the star icon on any profile's chip to mark it as the baseline. Once set:

- every other profile's cells are colored relative to the baseline's value, not just relative to each other,
- the baseline's own column is tinted throughout to keep it visually anchored,
- the “vs Baseline” view mode becomes available,
- both exported reports switch to a baseline-relative format with recommended actions per profile (section 10).

Click the star again to unset it. Only one profile can be the baseline at a time.

6. Excluding Parameters

Some differences are expected and not worth tracking — for example, a parameter tied to hostname, system size, or architecture that legitimately varies by design. Rather than letting these clutter your analysis, you can exclude them.

6.1 Marking a parameter as excluded

Tick the checkbox in the Excl. column on any row. The row is immediately dimmed and dropped out of the Matching/Different/Missing/Duplicates/Type Mismatch counts and views, though it's never fully hidden unless you choose to (section 6.3).

6.2 Adding a reason

Click the Exclusions button above the table to open the exclusions panel, which lists every excluded parameter with an editable text field. Use it to record why the parameter was excluded (for example, “expected to differ per system size”) — this reason is included in both exported reports, so anyone reviewing them later understands the exclusion wasn't an oversight.

6.3 Showing or hiding excluded rows

The Show excluded / Hide excluded toggle controls whether excluded rows appear in the table at all (dimmed) or are removed from view entirely. Exclusions themselves are unaffected either way — this only changes what's visible.

7. Ignoring SID-Based Differences

Some parameter values legitimately differ between systems only because each system's SID (or a hostname derived from it) appears inside the value — for example, xs4.example.com in one profile and ps4.example.com in another. The “Ignore SID differences” toggle, shown above the table whenever at least one profile has a detected SID, treats these as matching rather than different.

When it's turned on, any row resolved this way still shows the small blue “SID” badge described in section 3.2, so you can always see which matches were only matches because of this normalization, rather than the difference disappearing silently. A “SID-normalized” count also appears among the summary statistics while the toggle is active.

8. Proposing Fixes (Remediation Workflow)

Once you've identified real differences that need fixing, you can record exactly what should change in each profile — without losing sight of the original difference — and later export that as an actionable plan.

8.1 Opening the propose-fix panel

On any Different or Missing row, click the wrench icon next to the parameter name. A panel expands beneath the row listing every profile.

8.2 Choosing an action per profile

For each profile, choose one of:

- **Keep as is** — no change needed in this profile (the default).
- **Set value...** — type the value this profile should be changed to.
- **Remove parameter** — propose deleting the parameter from this profile entirely.

Different profiles can have different actions for the same parameter — for example, setting a specific value in one system while removing the parameter altogether in another.

8.3 Matching the baseline value

If a baseline is set, a Match baseline button appears next to every non-baseline profile in the panel. Clicking it fills that profile's action in as “Set value” using the baseline's current value, saving you from typing it manually.

8.4 Adding notes

The Notes for the Basis team field lets you record context for whoever will apply the fix — for example, a reason, a change-ticket reference, or a caution.

8.5 Marking a decision

Tick Mark as decided once you're satisfied with the proposal. This is a deliberate, separate step from filling in the actions — you can adjust dropdowns and notes freely before committing to a decision. A parameter with no changes needed in any profile can still be marked as decided; it will show up in the export as “reviewed, no action needed” rather than being lost.

Use Clear proposal to remove the proposal for that parameter entirely, or Close to collapse the panel without losing what you've entered.

8.6 Tracking progress

A Decided stat card above the table shows how many of your actionable (Different/Missing) parameters have a decision, as a fraction. The green checkmark badge described in section 3.2 marks decided rows directly in the table, and “Jump to next pending decision” (section 4.4) helps you work through what's left.

9. Saving and Loading Comparisons

Everything in the tool lives only in your browser tab and is lost if you close it or reload the page. To keep your work:

- **Save comparison** (top right) downloads a .json file containing the parsed comparison — all loaded profiles' parameters, your baseline choice, exclusions and their reasons, and every proposal you've made. This is not the original profile files themselves, just the analysis built from them.
- **Load comparison** restores a previously saved .json file exactly as it was, so you can pick up where you left off, or share your in-progress analysis with a colleague, without re-uploading anything.

10. Exporting Reports

Three different exports are available, each suited to a different purpose. All three are generated entirely in your browser.

10.1 Excel report

The Excel report button downloads a fully formatted, color-coded spreadsheet (.xls, opens natively in Excel) with six sheets:

- **Summary** — profiles compared, baseline (if any), and every summary count shown in the app (matching, different, missing, duplicates, type mismatches, SID-normalized, excluded).
- **Full Comparison** — every parameter and every profile's value, side by side, with status, exclusion, duplicate, and type-mismatch flags as extra columns. This is the complete raw dataset — use this sheet when you need to see everything, not just the differences.
- **Differences** — if a baseline is set, this lists every profile's current value against the baseline value with a specific Recommended Action per profile. If no baseline is set, it simply lists the differing values with a note that no baseline was specified.
- **Missing Parameters** — every parameter absent from at least one profile, showing which profiles have it and which don't.
- **Duplicates** — every duplicate parameter entry found, listed by profile, parameter, occurrence number, value, and the line number it appeared on in the source file.
- **Excluded Parameters** — every excluded parameter alongside the reason recorded for it.

Use the Excel report when you need the complete underlying data — for deeper analysis, filtering, or as a full audit record.

10.2 PDF comparison report

The PDF report button opens your browser's print dialog with a formatted summary document already laid out — choose “Save as PDF” as the destination to download it. It contains:

- summary statistic cards matching those shown in the app,
- a Differences section — against the baseline with recommended actions if one is set, or a plain list of differing values with no actions recommended if not,
- a Missing Parameters section,
- a Duplicate Parameter Entries section, and
- an Excluded from Analysis section, including reasons.

This report intentionally leaves out the full parameter-by-parameter table (that's what the Excel export is for) so it stays a concise, readable document — suitable for attaching to a ticket, sharing by email, or as a quick summary for someone who doesn't need the raw data.

10.3 Remediation plan (PDF)

The Remediation plan button is enabled once at least one proposal has been marked as decided (section 8.5). Unlike the general PDF report, this document is organized by profile rather than by parameter — each profile gets its own section listing exactly what needs to change in that specific system:

- parameter name,
- current value in that profile,
- the proposed action — either “Set to: [value]” or “Remove parameter”, and
- your note, if one was added.

It also includes a Reviewed — no action needed section for parameters you deliberately decided required no change, and a Still pending a decision list of every Different/Missing parameter that doesn't yet have a decision — so anyone reading the report can see at a glance what's actually finished versus still in progress.

This is the report to hand to your Basis team or to the owner of a specific system: they can go straight to their system's section and apply exactly what's listed, without needing to interpret a raw diff themselves.

10.4 Choosing the right export

Export	Best for
Excel report	Full raw data, further analysis, audit records
PDF comparison report	A concise summary to share or attach to a ticket
Remediation plan (PDF)	Handing off exact, per-system fix instructions to whoever will apply them

11. Quick Reference: Summary Statistics

The stat cards above the table always reflect the current state of your comparison (they update live as you exclude, propose, or toggle settings):

Card	What it counts
Parameters	Total distinct parameter names across all loaded profiles
Matching	Parameters identical across all profiles (excluding excluded ones)
Different	Parameters present everywhere but with differing values
Missing	Parameters absent from at least one profile

Duplicates	Parameters with duplicate entries in at least one profile's file
Type mismatches	Parameters flagged as numeric in one profile, text in another
Excluded	Parameters you've marked as excluded from analysis
Decided	Actionable (Different/Missing) parameters with a recorded proposal decision, shown as a fraction
SID-normalized	Only shown when "Ignore SID differences" is on — parameters treated as matching purely because of SID normalization

12. Tips for Basis Teams

1. Set a baseline profile whenever you're rolling out a standard configuration across systems — it turns the exercise from "spot the differences" into "show me exactly what's out of line with our standard."
2. Exclude parameters that vary by design (hostnames, system-specific sizing, instance numbers) early, with a clear reason — it keeps the Different/Missing counts meaningful for the rest of your review.
3. Turn on Ignore SID differences before comparing DEFAULT profiles across a landscape with several SIDs — it removes a very common source of false positives.
4. Use Jump to next pending decision to work through a remediation session systematically, parameter by parameter, rather than scrolling and searching.
5. Save your comparison before closing the tab if you haven't finished — there's no auto-save, and reloading the page loses everything not exported or saved.
6. Hand off the Remediation plan PDF, not the general PDF report, when you want someone else to actually make changes — it's structured specifically for that.

13. Data and Privacy

All parsing, comparison, and report generation happens locally in your browser. Profile files, parameter values, exclusions, and proposals are never sent to any server — closing the browser tab without saving or exporting discards everything. Saved comparison files and exported reports are written directly to your device's downloads.

14. Support and Contact

For questions, issues, or feature requests regarding SAP Profile Analyzer, please reach out:

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